

offered his customers: “You can have any color you want, as long as it’s black.”

I’ve just described the exact styles that Black uses; you can find Black’s full style guide at

https://black.readthedocs.io/en/stable/the_black_code_style.html.

Installing Black

Install Black using the `pip` tool that comes with Python. In Windows, do this by opening a Command Prompt window and entering the following:

```
C:\Users\Al>python -m pip install --user black
```

On macOS and Linux, open a Terminal window and enter `python3` rather than `python` (you should do this for all the instructions in this book that use `python`):

```
Als-MacBook-Pro:~ al$ python3 -m pip install --user black
```

The `-m` option tells Python to run the `pip` module as an application, which some Python modules are set up to do. Test that the installation was successful by running `python -m black`. You should see the message `No paths given. Nothing to do. rather than No module named black`.

Running Black from the Command Line

You can run Black for any Python file from the Command Prompt or Terminal window. In addition, your IDE or code editor can run Black in the background. You’ll find instructions for getting Black to work with Jupyter Notebook, Visual Studio Code, PyCharm, and other editors on Black’s home page at <https://github.com/psf/black/>.

Let’s say that you want to format a file called *yourScript.py* automatically. From the command line in Windows, run the following (on macOS and Linux, use the `python3` command instead of `python`):

```
C:\Users\Al>python -m black yourScript.py
```
